

## Who needs a camera anyway?

The latest camera phones could kill the digital camera market! It could happen! With Casio now offering a 3.2 megapixel camera phone, and almost all other brands—LG, Samsung, etc., offering 2 or 3 megapixel camera phones, who needs a standalone camera? Not unless you're a professional photographer!

Camera phones sales have shot up from 84 million in 2002, to almost five times that in 2004. Of course not everyone agrees: Casio spokesman, Toshihiro Watanabe said, "A mobile phone is meant to be carried with you all the time, and its main purpose is not taking pictures. It's more for if you want to take a picture as a quick memo of something, or if you just happen to come across a shutter chance."

Others also argue that camera phones don't have the features of a good digital camera—storage capacity, anti-shake protection, CCD, etc. We agree, camera phones just can't match up to a good digital camera...yet!

## snapshot

There are **now 980 million active e-mail accounts around the world, and 40 per cent of those are corporate accounts.**

Source: The Radicati Group, Inc.

## North Korea immobilised

No there isn't a war on; but North Korea has just banned the use of mobile phones in the country. It was only in 2002 that mobile phones were introduced, and until a few weeks ago, foreign tourists were permitted to

carry them. The official reason cited is the recent train explosion in North Korea, but judging by the country's track record, one is more inclined to believe that this is just another excuse to control the dissemination of information.



## tomorrow's technology

### ASANP

ASANP or Automatic Switching of Network Access Points is the latest technology for mobile phones. It allows a mobile device to switch automatically between a GSM Mobile network and a WLAN, without the user noticing it. The new technology increases the current bandwidth of 9.6 Kbps for wireless networks to 11 Mbps.

ASANP facilitates voice, data and real-time video conferencing services. Once the technology is implemented, all Internet-ready devices will work on a cellular network or a wireless LAN. This would include 802.11b and Bluetooth.

An amazing feature of ASANP is that it will enable companies to locate its users.

A user can also be tracked from the IP address of the Wireless device's connection point. WLAN owners will enable them to utilise WiFi bandwidth that earlier remained untapped.

This technology will weed out several limitations imposed by some of today's mobile networks. Upgrading the bandwidth of existing networks would call for massive costs. If WiFi networks are tapped, there's much more bandwidth to be had. With higher bandwidth, today's voice applications are set to get a major boost. US-based Calypso Wireless is promoting this technology. It might take shorter than we think for mobile phone makers to come up with handsets with ASANP embedded.

## quoteworthy

"We are targeting more PC penetration and bringing cyber connectivity to every citizen."

"The 3G standard has been evolved but has not proved cost-effective."

Dayanidhi Maran, India's new Information Technology minister, referring to his aim of switching India from the 3G to the 4G standard.

"Offshoring hasn't eaten jobs. It is the dumbest argument ever put out, simply because it is election time."

Jack Welch, retired Chief Executive, General Electric, ridiculing suggestions that the weak jobs market in the US is a result of the movement of jobs abroad. He blamed politics for the recent backlash against offshoring.

"The report was purely a speculation. The company does not have any current plans of setting up a chip fabrication plant in India."

Varghese M. Thomas, Intel India spokesman, responding to reports of Intel setting up a chip manufacturing facility in Chennai.